RAPHAEL FERREIRA COELHO SANTOS

Lead Cloud Architect, Platform and DevOps | AWS, Google Cloud, Azure | Terraform, Kubernetes, FinOps

São Paulo, Brazil (UTC-3, overlaps US Eastern business hours) · Open to remote work as employee, B2B contractor or through an EOR

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SUMMARY

Cloud architect with 16 years in IT and 9 in DevOps and cloud platforms on AWS, Google Cloud and Azure. I lead the Cloud Center of Excellence architecture of a telecom operator and stay hands-on in Terraform, Kubernetes and the pipelines. Before that, I led pre-sales, landing zones, migrations, platform engineering and FinOps for banks, insurers and an energy exchange through IT consultancies.

KEY RESULTS

- **Account onboarding from 22 days to 2** with AWS Control Tower and Account Factory for Terraform, guardrails included (telecom CCoE).
- **$100K a month saved, $700K breakeven in 7 months**, after tracing an AWS Backup cost anomaly and redesigning the SCP guardrails (insurer).
- **Environment delivery from weeks to minutes** with reusable Terraform modules on AWS and Azure (Open Finance for three large banks).
- **Architectures behind the numbers:** a 20+ workload AWS platform for a health insurer, EKS on AWS Outposts for 5G core, a Backstage developer portal. 60+ write-ups and 77 Terraform modules are public.

SKILLS

AWS: Control Tower, Account Factory for Terraform, Organizations with SCPs and RCPs, IAM Identity Center, Transit Gateway, Outposts, EKS, ECS Fargate, Lambda, EventBridge, Step Functions, MSK, Aurora, Textract, Bedrock

Google Cloud, Azure, OCI: Shared VPC, private GKE, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, AlloyDB, BigQuery; AKS, Front Door, Private Link, Azure Pipelines; OCI hybrid networking

Kubernetes: EKS, GKE, AKS, OpenShift; multi-tenant clusters, upgrades, blue-green migrations; Helm, Argo CD, Istio

Platform and delivery: Terraform with tests, Backstage, Atlantis, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, keyless OIDC, canary

Security, FinOps, architecture: SCP and Config guardrails, KMS, WAF; CUR/FOCUS, cost forecasting; C4, business cases, migrations

EXPERIENCE

Lead Cloud Architect | Druid — Mar 2025 – Present

Remote · Cloud Center of Excellence (CCoE) of a telecom operator

- Lead the CCoE architecture that puts AWS and Azure under one governance model. Moved account vending to **AWS Control Tower and Account Factory for Terraform**, with identity, network and security guardrails applied on creation, so teams deploy on their own.
- Designed **EKS on AWS Outposts for 5G core network functions**: Multus with one subnet per traffic plane, BGP, Transit Gateway and Local Gateway, and a staged rollout from network to network functions.
- Designed the partner network integration over Transit Gateway peering for signaling and data, an Azure landing zone with private AKS behind Front Door and Private Link, and the AWS to Google Cloud and Azure map of the charging platform.
- Set the Terraform governance (boilerplate, CCoE-reviewed merge requests, apply through OIDC with no static keys) and the FinOps cycle with CUR/FOCUS exports, tag compliance and ML cost forecasting in QuickSight. Added AI agents that build applications from the IaC templates, with observability built in.

DevOps Engineer (freelance) | FIS — Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

Remote · freelance contract in parallel with the Druid role

- Terraform for AWS and EKS workloads, Azure Pipelines with canary releases, and FinOps habits for the DevOps team.

Lead Cloud Architect | TIVIT — Jan 2024 – Mar 2025

IT consultancy · client engagements · Remote

- Lead architect of the **AWS platform of a health insurer, with more than 20 workloads designed**: a multi-tenant EKS cluster with wave-based migration of integrators, B2C login on Cognito and ECS Fargate, event-driven regulatory reporting on EventBridge, SQS, Lambda and AWS Batch, a BFF for partners, and hybrid links to OCI.
- Cut that client's AWS Backup cost by **$100K a month** by tracing the anomaly and redesigning the SCP guardrails.

- Designed an OCR solution on Amazon Textract and Amazon Bedrock that reads contract data at scale, coordinated the new automation team and mentored junior architects.
- Built a **Backstage developer portal** with Terraform templates and a self-service catalog: a request becomes a pull request, an approval and an apply in the target account.
- On Azure, set IaC and DevOps governance for an insurer and automated VM provisioning (request to resource in about 15 minutes). On Google Cloud, designed Shared VPC for GKE and Cloud SQL and an AlloyDB migration.
- Ran pre-sales from client workshops to C4 diagrams, cost estimates and board business cases, and planned migrations to AWS, Google Cloud and OCI.

Lead Cloud Architect | Engineering Brasil — Jul 2022 – Dec 2023

IT consultancy · client engagements

- Led pre-sales architecture across Google Cloud, AWS and Azure and defined shared security, networking and IaC standards for the three clouds, including how they connect.
- Designed Kubernetes microservice platforms with CI/CD in GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps and Jenkins. For a benefits platform, compared ECS, EKS and Beanstalk on cost and operations and set a pipeline that builds the image once and promotes it to production.

Senior Software Engineer | Itaú Unibanco — Apr 2022 – Jul 2022

Consulting engagement

- Worked on Camada Zero, the move of core services from a monolith to microservices on Kubernetes: pipelines for monoliths, microservices, serverless and IaC, GitLab CI wired to Jira, cluster administration and images.

Cloud Architect | Grupo FCamara — Aug 2020 – Apr 2022

IT consultancy · client engagements

- Wrote Terraform modules for Azure, GKE and AWS for a digital bank, deployed OpenShift and set up Azure Pipelines with canary releases.
- Delivered the Open Finance infrastructure as code for three large Brazilian banks, with microservices on EKS and AKS.
- Reorganized the company's own AWS accounts and FinOps practice.

DevOps Engineer | BBCE (Brazilian energy exchange) — Mar 2020 – Aug 2020

Consulting engagement

- Terraform on AWS and EKS for the company's microservices, Azure Pipelines with canary deployments, and the first IaC and FinOps standards for the DevOps team.

Earlier experience

- **2017 to 2020, DevOps Engineer** at Mandic Cloud Solutions, Pitang and ViViTech (consulting engagements). Built an AWS landing zone in Terraform at Mandic (accounts, network, security, EKS), moved hand-built infrastructure to IaC and monoliths to Kubernetes and serverless, with GitLab CI, Jenkins and SonarQube.
- **2010 to 2017, infrastructure, network and Linux.** IT technician in the Military Police (2010–2011), network analyst at Logicalis (2011–2013), communications sergeant leading the communications section in the Brazilian Army (2013–2015), Linux analyst at Processor with Puppet, Ansible and Python (2015–2017).

OPEN SOURCE AND WRITING

automacao_terraform on GitHub: 77 Terraform modules for AWS, Google Cloud and Azure with tests and CI, plus 60+ architecture write-ups with diagrams and costs at raphaelfcs.github.io/portfolio.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate, Amazon Web Services (2023)
- FinOps Certified Engineer (2025) and FinOps Certified Practitioner (2024), plus FinOps and FOCUS courses (2024), FinOps Foundation
- The Linux Foundation: LFS162 DevOps and SRE (2025), LFS142 Backstage (2024). Google Cloud: Generative AI, LLMs and Responsible AI (2024), Google Cloud Essentials (2023)
- GitLab Certified Git Associate; AWS Educate Networking (2025); Kubernetes and Istio, LINUXtips; Cloud Solutions Architect and DevOps Engineer, FIAP (2022); English C2, International English Test (2024)

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

MBA in Technology Leadership (CTO/CIO), FIAP, 2024 – 2025 · **Associate Degree in Cloud Computing**, FIAP, 2020 – 2022
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, UniFieo, 2010 – 2013
Portuguese (native) · **English** (professional working proficiency)